

Practice Test 2 — Full Academic Mock

The second and final full mock of the course, taken after Lesson 4.3. It has the same shape as the real IELTS Academic test: Listening (4 sections, 40 questions), Reading (3 academic passages, 40 questions), Writing (Task 1 data report + Task 2 essay) and a Speaking interview in three parts. Every passage, script, chart, prompt and cue card here is original and was written for this course. It is not taken from, or adapted from, any published IELTS test. Use the results **diagnostically**: set them beside Practice Test 1 to see what has moved, what hasn't yet, and what each learner should do between now and test day.

Class 15: Listening ~27 min + Reading 60 min

Class 16: Writing 60 min + Speaking 11–14 min each

Listening /40 • Reading /40 • Writing & Speaking band estimates

Target band 6.0–7.5

HOW TO FRAME THE LAST MOCK

By Week 8, most learners have a real test date, and some have a university offer or a registration deadline riding on it. That is exactly why this mock should feel **calm and ordinary**. Say it plainly before you start: "**This is a rehearsal, not a verdict. It shows you where your marks are coming from and where you can still pick them up. Whatever the number, you will leave with a clear plan.**" Be honest about what a mock can and can't tell you: a band from one practice test can easily be half a band above or below what the same person would get on another day, so treat it as a **range**, not a prediction. Remind learners that a **0.5 band gain over eight weeks is common and worth celebrating**; a bigger jump happens for some people, but no course can promise it.

HOW TO USE THIS PACK

◆ WHAT EACH PART CHECKS

- ◆ **Listening /40** (Lesson 2.1): form completion with spelling and corrections (S1), multiple choice and plan labelling (S2), multiple choice and matching in an academic discussion (S3), note completion in a lecture (S4)
- ◆ **Reading /40** (Lessons 2.2–2.3): True/False/Not Given, note completion, matching headings, matching

◆ YOU NEED

- ◆ Per learner: the **Listening paper**, the **Reading paper**, the **Writing paper**, and one copy of each **answer sheet**. Print at 100% so the plan, the graph and the writing lines stay usable
- ◆ The teacher pages: listening scripts (Class 15) and the speaking run-sheet, cue cards and record forms

features, sentence completion, Yes/No/Not Given, multiple choice, and summary completion from a box

- ◆ **Writing** (Lessons 3.1–3.3): a line-graph report (150+ words) and a "discuss both views" essay (250+ words), estimated on the four paraphrased criteria
- ◆ **Speaking** (Lessons 4.1–4.2): Parts 1–3, estimated on the four paraphrased criteria
- ◆ Paraphrase (1.2) and grammar range (1.3) run through every part

(Class 16)

- ◆ A clock or timer the whole room can see, pencils, erasers
- ◆ The key: `assessment/practice-test-2-key.html` (answers with evidence, raw-score conversion, model answers, band-estimation sheets and the debrief plan)
- ◆ Each learner's Practice Test 1 results (`assessment/practice-test-1.html`, keys in `assessment/answer-keys.html`) for the Class 16 comparison

RUNNING CLASS 15 — LISTENING + READING (90 MIN)

This class is tight by design: it has the same timing as the real test. **Set the room up before learners arrive** (papers face down, one answer sheet on top, bags and phones at the side) so the whole 90 minutes is available.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Settle & rules	2 min	T-S	One slow breath together. Then give the rules exactly as in the test: you will hear each recording once only ; write answers on the question paper as you listen; you will have 2 minutes at the end to copy them onto the answer sheet. Tell learners that on the paper-based test they get 10 minutes to transfer, and on the computer-based test they type as they go, so 2 minutes is a fair middle. Remind them: no penalty for wrong answers, so never leave a blank.
Listening S1–S4	25 min	T-S	Read the four scripts on the teacher pages once each , at a natural pace, observing every [PAUSE] . Don't repeat, rephrase or slow down for a word. If someone clearly missed a whole section because of a noise outside, note it on their paper and move on. For Section 3, use three distinct voices or ask a colleague to read one part.
Transfer & check	2 min	S	Learners copy answers 1–40 onto the Listening answer sheet. "Check spelling, plurals and word limits. Fill every blank."
Reading	60 min	S	Collect the Listening papers, then say "Turn over the Reading paper. You have one hour. There is no extra time to transfer answers." Write the checkpoints on the board: :20 → Passage 2 · :40 → Passage 3 · :55 → fill every blank . Announce the time at 20, 40 and 55 minutes, then say nothing else. Don't help with vocabulary.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Close	1 min	T-S	Collect everything. Thank them, and name the effort, not the outcome: "An hour and a half of full concentration is a real achievement." Remind them that Class 16 is Writing, then speaking and results.

BETWEEN CLASSES 15 AND 16

Mark Listening and Reading with the key before Class 16 (about 3 minutes per learner once you know the answers). Write each raw score and the **approximate** band on a slip for each learner, beside their Practice Test 1 bands. Don't write comments on the scripts yet; learners will analyze their own errors in Class 16, which teaches them more than reading yours.

RUNNING CLASS 16 — WRITING, SPEAKING, DEBRIEF (90 MIN)

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Settle	3 min	T-S	Hand out the Writing paper face down. Rules: 60 minutes for both tasks; the clock is theirs to manage, but you recommend 20 minutes for Task 1 and 40 minutes for Task 2 , because Task 2 carries more weight. Pencil is fine. Word counts matter: 150+ and 250+.
Writing Tasks 1+2	60 min	S	Silent, timed. Announce "20 minutes: you should be moving on to Task 2" and "5 minutes left". Early finishers check their overview (Task 1) and their position in the introduction and conclusion (Task 2). Don't run speaking interviews during this hour: every minute outside the room is a minute of writing lost.
Break & collect	5 min	—	Collect the Writing papers. Set up the speaking corner (two chairs, a timer, the cue cards, record forms).
Results + speaking	17 min	S · S-S · T-S	Return the Listening and Reading answer sheets with the result slips. Learners use the key's error-analysis grid to code every wrong answer with the same error codes as Practice Test 1 (Listening D S W N L P X ; Reading P M S W O T F K Q H X) and fill in the PT1 → PT2 band tracker . At the same time, run the speaking interviews in the corner, following the run-sheet on the teacher pages.
Next steps & celebration	5 min	T-S · S	Each learner writes one sentence: "The one change with the biggest payoff for my band is ___, and this week I will ___" (the Lesson 4.3 journal prompt). Then celebrate what the group has done over eight weeks. Tell them when they will receive their Writing and Speaking estimates.

ACCESS ARRANGEMENTS AND LEARNERS WITH LITERACY GAPS

The real IELTS offers arrangements (extra time, enlarged print, a scribe and others) to candidates who apply in advance with evidence; tell any learner who might qualify to ask their test center **well before** the booking deadline. In this mock, mirror what they would really get. If a learner writes much more slowly than they speak, don't change the tasks. Give extra time only if they will have it on the day, and write **"Adapted: +__ min"** on the paper so that the comparison with Practice Test 1 stays honest. For low vision, print the paper at 141% (A4 to A3) and give the Task 1 data table from the teacher pages alongside the graph. A slow writer is not a weak thinker: in the debrief, separate "I ran out of time" from "I didn't know what to write".

PERSONAL INFORMATION AND OPINIONS ARE ALWAYS OPTIONAL

The speaking cue cards ask about a place, a person and a piece of technology; Part 1 asks about everyday life. No question asks about home country, family members, immigration or status, and you should not add follow-ups that do. Tell every candidate before they start: **"You can answer as yourself or invent the details. I'm listening to your English, not checking your life."** The same goes for the Task 2 essay: learners may argue whichever side they can develop best.

Listening

Name: _____ Date: _____ Class: _____

Time: about 30 minutes. There are four sections and 40 questions. You will hear each section **once only**. Write your answers on this paper as you listen. At the end you will have time to copy them onto the answer sheet. Check every word limit, your spelling, and your plurals.

Section 1 • Questions 1–10

___ / 10

Questions 1–10

Complete the form below. Write **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER** for each answer.

Riverside Community Garden — New Member Form	
Name	Daniel (1) _____
Phone number	(2) _____
Plot size	(3) _____ plot
Annual fee	\$ (4) _____
Before starting	must attend an (5) _____ session
Date of session	Saturday, March (6) _____, 10 a.m.
Members must bring	their own (7) _____
Tool shed key	kept at the (8) _____ across the road
Help with shared areas	(9) _____ hours per month
Heard about the garden through	the (10) _____

Questions 11–14

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

11 The lamp in Harbor Point Lighthouse was first lit in

A 1868.

B 1886.

C 1906.

12 Why did the lighthouse keepers leave?

A An automatic lamp was installed.

B The keeper's cottage was damaged by a storm.

C The cost of running the lighthouse rose.

13 Visitors who want to climb the tower must

A book a time at the Visitor Center.

B be at least twelve years old.

C wear suitable shoes.

14 The steps down to the tide pools are closed

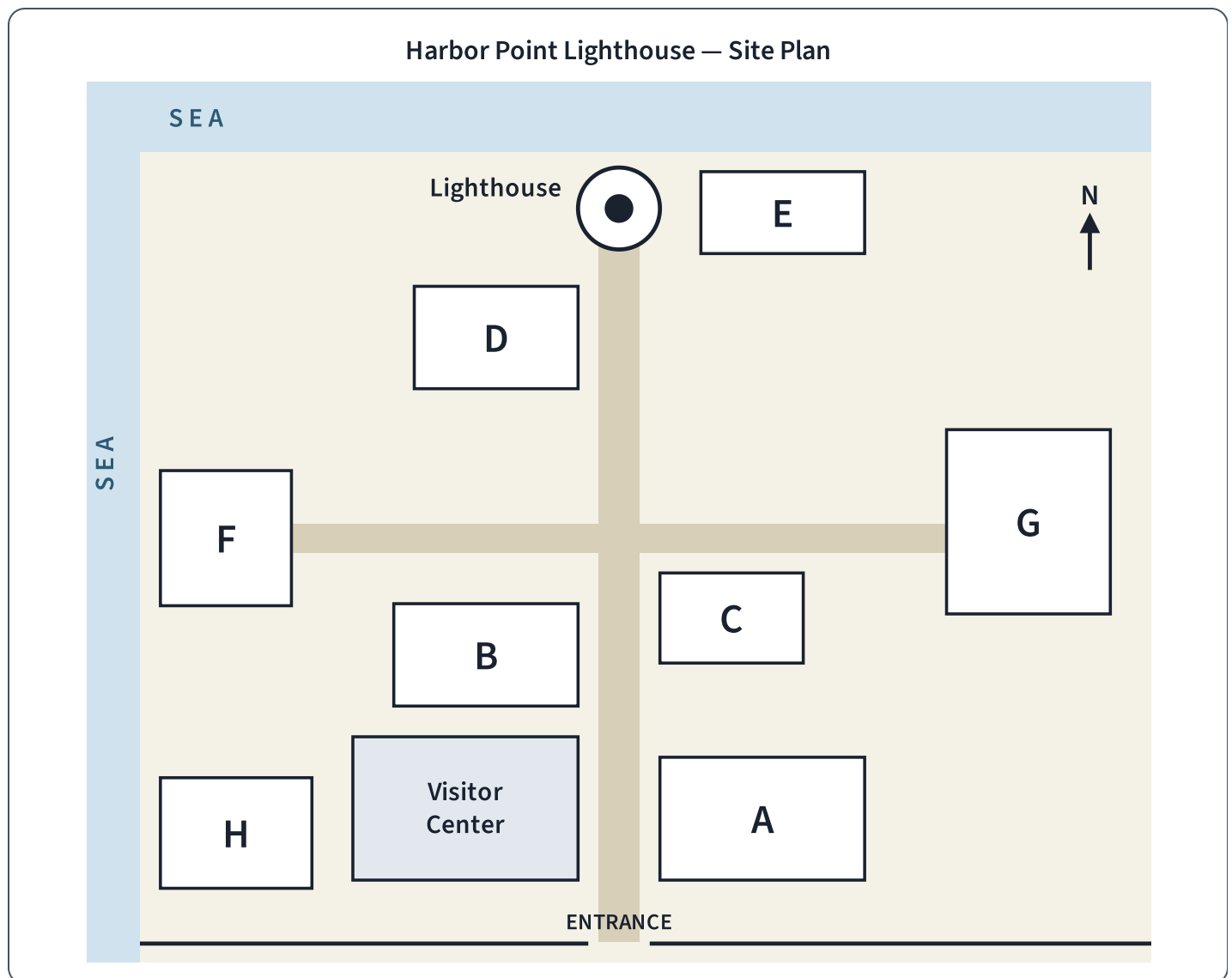
A during the winter months.

B around the time of high tide.

C every afternoon.

Questions 15–20

Label the plan below. Write the correct letter, A–H, next to Questions 15–20.



- 15 café _____
- 16 gift shop _____
- 17 picnic area _____
- 18 steps to the tide pools _____
- 19 keeper's cottage exhibition _____
- 20 lookout platform _____

Questions 21–25

Choose the correct letter, A, B or C.

- 21** Why did the students choose the Millbrook museum for their project?
- A It is close to their campus.
 - B Its director asked for students' help.
 - C It has recently changed its layout.
- 22** What did the students notice in the entrance hall?
- A Visitors spent a long time there.
 - B The floor map was difficult to read.
 - C Most visitors ignored the floor map.
- 23** What does Dr. Hart see as the main weakness of the observations so far?
- A They all took place at weekends.
 - B Too few visitors were observed.
 - C Visitors knew they were being watched.
- 24** What do the students agree about the timeline wall?
- A It should be moved to a quieter space.
 - B Its texts are too long.
 - C Visitors rarely stop there.
- 25** How will the students record the time visitors spend at each exhibit?
- A with small video cameras
 - B with a stopwatch app
 - C with a paper grid

Questions 26–30

What do the students decide to recommend for each area of the museum? Choose **FIVE** answers from the box and write the correct letter, **A–G**, next to Questions 26–30.

A add seating

C improve the signs

E reduce the number of items

G move it to another room

B add a hands-on activity

D change the lighting

F add audio descriptions

26 the entrance hall _____

27 the farm tools gallery _____

28 the textile room _____

29 the old schoolroom _____

30 the photograph corridor _____

Questions 31–40

Complete the notes below. Write **ONE WORD ONLY** for each answer.

The Acoustics of Concert Halls**Reverberation**

- sound that continues after the source stops, caused by (31) _____ from the walls, ceiling and floor
- about two seconds is ideal for orchestral music; a shorter time is better for (32) _____

The first scientific study (around 1900)

- a young physics lecturer timed sound with an organ pipe and a (33) _____
- he reduced reverberation using (34) _____ borrowed from a nearby theater

Hall shapes

- "shoebox" halls: tall and narrow; reflections from the (35) _____ walls make listeners feel surrounded by sound
- "vineyard" halls: the audience sits on (36) _____ around the stage

Materials and problems

- seats are designed to absorb about as much sound when they are (37) _____ as when someone is sitting in them
- curved walls can focus sound and cause (38) _____
- irregular surfaces called (39) _____ scatter sound in many directions

Modern halls

- heavy fabric (40) _____ can be lowered to shorten reverberation for amplified concerts

End of the Listening test. Now copy your answers onto the answer sheet.

Listening Answer Sheet

Name: _____

Date: _____

Raw score: / 40

Write clearly. You may use CAPITAL LETTERS. Leave the narrow right-hand column for marking.

1		✓ X	21		✓ X
2		✓ X	22		✓ X
3		✓ X	23		✓ X
4		✓ X	24		✓ X
5		✓ X	25		✓ X
6		✓ X	26		✓ X
7		✓ X	27		✓ X
8		✓ X	28		✓ X
9		✓ X	29		✓ X
10		✓ X	30		✓ X
11		✓ X	31		✓ X
12		✓ X	32		✓ X
13		✓ X	33		✓ X
14		✓ X	34		✓ X
15		✓ X	35		✓ X
16		✓ X	36		✓ X
17		✓ X	37		✓ X
18		✓ X	38		✓ X
19		✓ X	39		✓ X
20		✓ X	40		✓ X

Academic Reading

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

Time: 60 minutes. There are three passages and 40 questions. Spend about 20 minutes on each passage. Write your answers on the Reading answer sheet **as you go**: there is no extra time for transferring answers.

Reading Passage 1 • Questions 1–13

___ / 13

You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 1–13**, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.

Rebuilding the Oyster Reef

For most people, an oyster is something that arrives on a plate. For marine ecologists, it is one of the hardest-working animals on the coast. Oysters are filter feeders: they draw water across their gills, trap tiny particles of algae and sediment, and release the water cleaner than before. A single adult can filter dozens of gallons in a day, and when millions of oysters settle together on a reef, the effect on a bay can be dramatic. The water becomes clearer, sunlight reaches further down, and seagrass beds, which shelter young fish and crabs, are able to grow.

Oyster reefs were once a common feature of estuaries in many parts of the world. Early records from coastal settlements describe reefs so large that they were marked on navigation charts as hazards to shipping. Over the past two centuries, however, most of these reefs have disappeared. One widely cited global estimate puts the loss at around 85 percent, which would make oyster reefs one of the most severely reduced marine habitats on the planet. Overharvesting was the first and most obvious cause: reefs were dredged so intensively that the shell base itself was carried away. Disease, pollution, and the silt that rivers washed down from cleared land then made recovery harder.

The loss of the shell base matters more than it might seem. Young oysters, known as spat, spend their first days as free-swimming larvae. To survive, they must settle on a hard surface, and they show a strong preference for the shells of other oysters. Once a reef has been dredged flat, there is little for the larvae to land on, and those that settle on soft mud are quickly buried. In other words,

a damaged reef cannot simply be left alone to recover: the habitat that once allowed it to rebuild itself has gone.

Restoration projects therefore begin by putting that hard surface back. In some bays, old shells are collected from restaurants and seafood processors, left in the open air for several months so that any disease dies off, and then returned to the water in carefully placed mounds. Where shell is scarce, engineers have experimented with alternatives, including limestone rock, recycled concrete, and specially designed ceramic units. Early trials suggested that the larvae were not particularly selective about the material, provided that the surface was rough and stood clear of the mud. Researchers have since found that the height of a structure matters more than what it is made of: reefs built only a few centimeters high tend to silt over within a season or two, while taller mounds keep their upper layers clean.

In waters where few wild larvae remain, volunteers play a surprisingly large role. In several coastal communities, homeowners with waterfront access hang cages of young oysters from their docks, where the animals grow for about a year before being moved to a protected reef. The approach, known as oyster gardening, produces relatively small numbers of animals, but organizers argue that its greatest value lies elsewhere. Participants become informed supporters of the wider restoration effort, and many go on to monitor water quality near their homes, adding to the data that scientists rely on.

Rebuilt reefs offer benefits beyond cleaner water. Because they rise from the seabed, they slow waves before those waves reach the shore, and several projects have placed reefs deliberately to reduce the erosion of salt marshes and beaches. Compared with concrete sea walls, living reefs have one notable advantage: they can grow upward as sea levels rise, at least up to a point. Researchers stress, however, that reefs are not a substitute for engineered defenses where storms are severe. Their protective effect is greatest in sheltered bays, where waves are modest.

Measuring success has proved difficult. A reef may look healthy in its first year, while the transplanted oysters are thriving, and then decline once they die if no new larvae settle. For this reason, many scientists now argue that a project should be judged successful only when the reef has shown natural reproduction for several consecutive years. Monitoring for this long is expensive, and funding is often provided for the construction phase alone, which leaves a gap between what has been built and what is actually known about it.

Despite these challenges, the outlook is more hopeful than it was two decades ago. Restoration techniques have improved, harvesting rules in many regions are stricter, and fishing communities that once saw restoration as a threat have in some cases become its partners, recognizing that a healthy reef eventually supports a more reliable harvest. Nobody expects the vast reefs of earlier centuries to return in full. The evidence increasingly suggests, however, that when oysters are given a firm place to settle and time to grow, they are capable of doing much of the rebuilding themselves.

Questions 1–6

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 1? Write

TRUE if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this

- 1 Clearer water allows seagrass to grow.
- 2 Pollution was the main reason why oyster reefs first began to decline.
- 3 Shells collected from restaurants are put back into the water straight away.
- 4 Ceramic reef units cost more to produce than recycled concrete.
- 5 The height of an artificial reef affects whether it becomes covered in silt.
- 6 Oyster gardening is the most popular form of volunteering in coastal communities.

Questions 7–13

Complete the notes below. Choose **NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS** from the passage for each answer.

Oyster Reef Restoration

Why reefs struggle to recover

- rivers carried silt from (7) _____
- young oysters, called (8) _____, need a hard place to settle

Rebuilding

- larvae will settle on most materials if the surface is (9) _____ and above the mud
- in oyster gardening, young oysters grow in cages hung from (10) _____
- many volunteers later check (11) _____ close to where they live

Protecting the shore

- unlike sea walls, reefs can (12) _____ as the sea rises
- reefs work best as protection in (13) _____

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 14–26, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.

Farming Without Fields

Can vertical farms change the way cities are fed?

A Picture a warehouse on the edge of a city. Inside, there is no soil, no sunlight and no change of season: only tall racks of lettuce, basil and spinach growing in stacked trays under rows of pink-and-blue lights. The roots of the plants hang in shallow channels of water enriched with exactly the nutrients each crop requires. This is a vertical farm, and in the past fifteen years such farms have moved from research laboratories into commercial buildings in many parts of the world. Supporters describe them as the future of food. Critics call them an expensive answer to a problem that ordinary farms already solve perfectly well.

B The case in favor begins with resources. Because the water in a vertical farm circulates in a closed system and is recycled rather than draining into the ground, operators commonly report using a small fraction of the water needed to grow the same crop outdoors. Stacking crops in layers also means that a building with a modest footprint can produce as much as many acres of open land. And because the growing rooms are sealed, insects and other pests find it very hard to get in, so chemical pesticides are rarely needed.

C A second advantage is location. A vertical farm can be built inside a city, close to the people who will eat what it grows. Leafy greens harvested in the morning can be on supermarket shelves by the afternoon, instead of spending several days in a refrigerated truck. The produce therefore tends to last longer once it reaches the customer's kitchen, and less is thrown away along the way. Retailers, for their part, value a supply that does not depend on the weather or on long-distance transport. Dr. Amina Osei, a plant scientist who has advised several growers, believes that this is where the real commercial value lies. "Companies talk a great deal about saving water," she says, "but when you ask shoppers why they buy the product, the answer is almost always that it stays fresh for longer."

D The central difficulty is energy. Sunlight is free; electric light is not. Lighting and climate control make energy the largest single operating cost for most vertical farms, and it rises and falls with the price of electricity. Professor Martin Keller, an energy economist, has calculated the cost of

growing staple foods under lights and concludes that it would be wildly uneconomic for grains such as wheat or rice. This explains why nearly every vertical farm grows the same narrow range of crops: leafy greens and herbs, which grow quickly, are mostly water, and sell for a relatively high price per kilogram. Potatoes, cereals and most fruit remain far beyond what the technology can produce at a sensible cost. Even for leafy greens, profit margins are thin: a small change in the price of electricity can decide whether a harvest makes money or loses it.

E The industry has already had painful lessons. In recent years, a number of well-funded vertical farming companies have closed or sharply reduced their operations, most often after energy prices rose faster than they had planned for. According to Keller, the firms that came through this period in better shape tended to share one feature: they had located their farms next to a cheap and stable power supply, such as a hydroelectric plant, or had arranged to use waste heat from a neighboring factory. "In this business," he argues, "where you plug in can matter more than what you grow."

F At the same time, the technology is improving. Lighting has become far more efficient over the last decade, and growers can now adjust the color and timing of light to suit each stage of a plant's life. Some researchers believe the next gains will come from the plants themselves. Dr. Rosa Lindqvist, a horticulturist, points out that almost every crop variety grown today was bred to cope with outdoor life, including wind, strong sun and uneven rainfall. Plants bred specifically for indoor conditions, she suggests, could be more compact, grow faster and waste less energy on features they no longer need. Lindqvist is more cautious about automation, however. Robots that move trays and harvest crops can reduce labor costs, she notes, but they bring expenses of their own, from purchase to maintenance.

G What, then, is the realistic future of farming without fields? Most researchers now see vertical farms as a complement to conventional agriculture rather than a replacement for it. They make the most sense in places where fresh produce is otherwise difficult to supply: desert cities that import most of their vegetables, northern regions with long, dark winters, or crowded cities where land is extremely expensive. "The question was never whether vertical farms could feed the world. They can't," says Osei. "The useful question is where they make sense, and for which crops."

Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has seven paragraphs, **A–G**. Choose the correct heading for paragraphs **B–G** from the list of headings below. Write the correct number, **i–x**. There are more headings than paragraphs.

- i** A new kind of farm and the debate around it
- ii** Why some companies closed and others survived
- iii** The rising price of farmland near cities
- iv** Using fewer natural resources
- v** How robots are replacing farm workers
- vi** The value of being close to the customer
- vii** Where indoor farming fits best
- viii** Why energy limits what can be grown
- ix** Consumer doubts about food grown without soil
- x** Improving the light and the plants

e.g. Paragraph A **i**

14 Paragraph B _____

15 Paragraph C _____

16 Paragraph D _____

17 Paragraph E _____

18 Paragraph F _____

19 Paragraph G _____

Questions 20–23

Look at the following statements (Questions 20–23) and the list of people below. Match each statement with the correct person, **A**, **B** or **C**. **NB** You may use any letter more than once.

- A** Dr. Amina Osei
- B** Professor Martin Keller
- C** Dr. Rosa Lindqvist

20 Customers care more about how long the product lasts than about environmental benefits.

- 21 A farm's source of power may decide whether the business survives. _____
- 22 Machines can reduce one cost while adding others. _____
- 23 Vertical farms will never be able to feed the world's population. _____

Questions 24–26

Complete the sentences below. Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.

- 24 In a vertical farm, the plants' roots hang in channels of _____ that contain nutrients.
- 25 Vertical farms rarely use chemical pesticides because the growing rooms are _____ .
- 26 Most modern crop varieties were bred to survive strong sun, uneven rainfall and _____ .

You should spend about 20 minutes on Questions 27–40, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.

The Stubborn Science of Habit

Why good intentions so often fail, and what works instead

Every January, gyms fill with new members and then, by the middle of February, quietly empty again. The pattern is so familiar that it is usually put down to weak willpower. Yet several decades of research in psychology suggest that this explanation is not only unkind but largely mistaken. The people who succeed in changing their behavior are not, on the whole, those with the most self-control. They are the people who have arranged their lives, often without realizing it, so that they need to use self-control as little as possible.

A habit, in the psychological sense, is not simply something we do often. It is a behavior that has become linked to a particular cue, such as a place, a time of day, or a preceding action, so that the cue triggers the behavior with very little conscious thought. Brushing one's teeth after breakfast is a classic example: few people stop to deliberate about it. This automatic quality is exactly what makes habits valuable. Some diary studies have suggested that roughly two in five of our everyday actions are repeated in the same setting almost every day. Because these actions run without much thought, they free up mental resources and leave more attention for the decisions that genuinely need it.

How long does it take to form a new habit? Popular advice often gives a precise answer, usually twenty-one days. The origin of this figure is obscure, and in my view it has done real harm, because people who have not "got the habit" by the third week tend to conclude that they have failed and give up. Research that has followed volunteers as they tried to build new routines paints a far more varied picture. In one well-known study, the time it took for a simple daily behavior, such as drinking a glass of water after breakfast, to feel automatic ranged from a few weeks to most of a year, with an average of around two months. Encouragingly, the same study found that missing an occasional day made little difference to progress.

If willpower is not the key, what is? Much of the answer lies in the environment. Researchers have repeatedly found that small changes in convenience have surprisingly large effects on what people do. In workplace experiments, simply moving healthier food to the front of a cafeteria

counter increased how often it was chosen, even though nothing else had changed. People who have to walk past the stairs before they reach the elevator use the stairs more often. The principle works in both directions: adding a little effort to an unwanted behavior, such as keeping snacks on a high shelf, makes it less likely. To my mind, this is the most practical finding in the whole field, and also the most neglected.

Habits are also especially fragile at moments of transition. Moving to a new home, starting a new job or retiring disrupts the cues that used to trigger our routines, and for a while old habits lose some of their grip. Some researchers describe this period as a window of opportunity. In one study, people who had recently moved house were more likely than long-term residents to change the way they traveled to work after receiving information about local bus routes. I would argue that organizations hoping to encourage healthier behavior would do well to focus their efforts on such moments, rather than spreading them evenly across everyone.

Breaking a bad habit, however, is harder than forming a good one, because the link between cue and response survives even when motivation disappears. Someone who has decided to stop checking a phone during dinner may still find a hand reaching for it the moment it buzzes. Simply trying not to respond, a strategy psychologists call suppression, takes considerable effort, and it tends to fail when people are tired or under stress, which is precisely when old habits are strongest. Two approaches work better. The first is to remove the cue altogether, for instance by leaving the phone in another room. The second is to keep the cue but attach a different behavior to it, such as reaching for a glass of water instead.

Rewards matter too, but not all rewards are equal. The brain responds far more strongly to what happens now than to what might happen later. This is a serious problem for many healthy behaviors, whose benefits are real but distant: the reward for regular exercise may not be felt for months. One practical solution is to pair the behavior with something enjoyable that happens at once, for example allowing oneself to listen to a favorite podcast only while out walking.

None of this means that individuals carry no responsibility for their choices, or that environment is destiny. But I am convinced that the language of willpower, with its suggestion of personal weakness, discourages people from making the practical changes that actually work. A person who says, "I lack discipline" has diagnosed a flaw in their character, and there is little they can do about it by Monday. A person who says, "My running shoes are at the back of the closet" has identified a problem that can be solved in thirty seconds.

Questions 27–31

Do the following statements agree with the views of the writer in Reading Passage 3? Write

YES if the statement agrees with the views of the writer

NO if the statement contradicts the views of the writer

NOT GIVEN if it is impossible to say what the writer thinks about this

- 27 Weak willpower is the main reason why people fail to change their behavior.
-
- 28 The idea that a habit forms in twenty-one days has discouraged some people.
-
- 29 The study of volunteers building new routines included too few participants.
-
- 30 Changing people's surroundings is an under-used way of changing their behavior.
-
- 31 Most people who move house want to change their daily routines.
-

Questions 32–35

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

- 32 According to the second paragraph, what makes a behavior a habit?
- A It is repeated many times each day.
 - B It is started by a cue with little conscious thought.
 - C It is something the person enjoys doing.
 - D It has been performed for at least three weeks.
- 33 What did the study of volunteers find?
- A Most new habits became automatic within a month.
 - B Complex behaviors became automatic faster than simple ones.
 - C Missing a day now and then did not seriously slow progress.
 - D Drinking water was the easiest habit to form.

- 34 According to the writer, trying hard not to respond to a cue
- A is least likely to succeed when people are tired or stressed.
 - B works well if the cue is removed at the same time.
 - C is the method psychologists most often recommend.
 - D is effective for people with strong motivation.
- 35 Why does the writer mention running shoes in the final paragraph?
- A to show that exercise habits are the easiest ones to change
 - B to suggest that the right equipment improves motivation
 - C to give an example of an immediate reward
 - D to contrast a practical explanation with one based on character

Questions 36–40

Complete the summary using the list of words, A–J, below.

How habits work

A habit is a behavior connected to a (36) _____, such as a particular place or time. Habits are useful because they save (37) _____ for more important decisions. Research suggests that making a behavior more (38) _____ is a powerful way to encourage it. Old habits can also weaken during a period of (39) _____, such as starting a new job. To stop an unwanted habit, (40) _____ the cue works better than simply trying to resist it.

- | | |
|--------------|--------------|
| A cue | B attention |
| C convenient | D transition |
| E motivation | F removing |
| G reward | H difficult |
| I routine | J ignoring |

End of the Reading test.

Reading Answer Sheet

Name: _____

Date: _____

Raw score: / 40

Write each answer as you find it. For True/False/Not Given and Yes/No/Not Given, write the words the instructions ask for (you may write T / F / NG or Y / N / NG). Leave the narrow column for marking.

1		✓ X	21		✓ X
2		✓ X	22		✓ X
3		✓ X	23		✓ X
4		✓ X	24		✓ X
5		✓ X	25		✓ X
6		✓ X	26		✓ X
7		✓ X	27		✓ X
8		✓ X	28		✓ X
9		✓ X	29		✓ X
10		✓ X	30		✓ X
11		✓ X	31		✓ X
12		✓ X	32		✓ X
13		✓ X	33		✓ X
14		✓ X	34		✓ X
15		✓ X	35		✓ X
16		✓ X	36		✓ X
17		✓ X	37		✓ X
18		✓ X	38		✓ X
19		✓ X	39		✓ X

20		✓ x	40		✓ x
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Academic Writing

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

Time: 60 minutes. There are two tasks. Answer both. Task 2 carries more weight than Task 1, so plan your time: about **20 minutes for Task 1** and **40 minutes for Task 2**. Write in full sentences, not notes or bullet points.

Writing Task 1

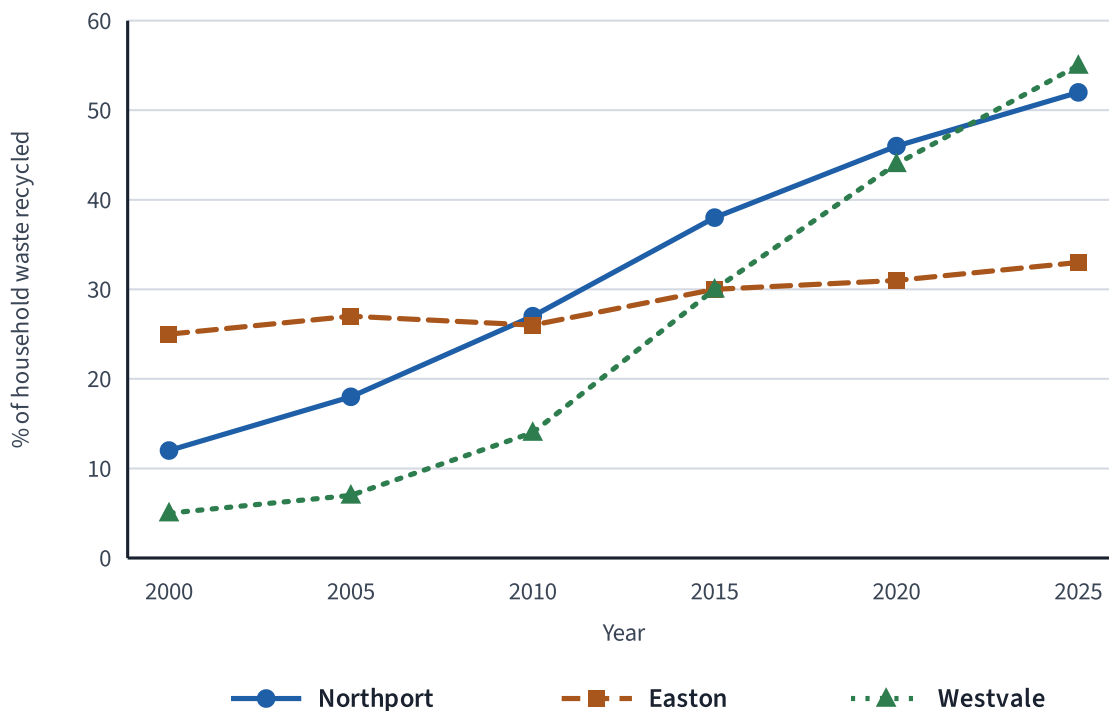
about 20 min · 150+ words

The graph below shows the percentage of household waste that was recycled in three cities, Northport, Easton and Westvale, between 2000 and 2025.

Summarize the main features of the graph, and make comparisons where they are relevant.

Write at least 150 words.

Household waste recycled in three cities, 2000–2025 (%)



Plan here (not marked):

Write your answer here:

Word count (approx.): _____

Writing Task 2

about 40 min · 250+ words

Write about the following topic:

Some people think that museums and art galleries should be free for everyone to visit.

Others believe that visitors should pay an entrance fee.

Discuss both views and give your own opinion.

Support your answer with reasons and with relevant examples from your own knowledge or experience.

Write at least 250 words.

Plan here (not marked): question type · my position · Body 1 · Body 2

Write your answer here (continue on the back or on extra paper if you need to):

[illegible]

Word count (approx.): _____

End of the Writing test. Check: an overview in Task 1? A clear position in Task 2?

FOR THE TEACHER	TASK ACHIEVEMENT / RESPONSE	COHERENCE & COHESION	LEXICAL RESOURCE	GRAMMATICAL RANGE & ACCURACY	TASK BAND
Task 1					
Task 2					
Estimated Writing band (Task 2 counts about twice as much as Task 1; see the key)					

LISTENING SCRIPTS · CLASS 15

Read each section **once only**, as in the real test. Keep a natural pace (about the speed of a clear radio presenter) with ordinary contractions. When a speaker corrects themselves, don't stress the correction more than the rest: catching it is the skill being tested. Time every **[PAUSE]** with a watch; learners use it to read ahead. Numbers, dates and spellings are read exactly as written. For Section 3, move your position or change your voice for each speaker, or share the reading with a colleague.

◆ SECTION 1 · RIVERSIDE COMMUNITY GARDEN (QUESTIONS 1–10)

READ ALOUD

Section 1. You will hear a telephone conversation between a woman who works for a community garden and a man who would like to join. First, you have some time to look at questions 1 to 5. **[PAUSE 30 SECONDS]** Now listen carefully and answer questions 1 to 5.

Maya: Good morning, Riverside Community Garden, Maya speaking.

Daniel: Oh, hi. I saw that you have some garden plots available, and I'd like to find out about joining.

Maya: Of course. I can take your details now and put you on the list. Could I have your name first?

Daniel: Sure. It's Daniel Thorley.

Maya: Could you spell your last name for me?

Daniel: T-H-O-R-L-E-Y.

Maya: T-H-O-R-L-E-Y. Thanks, Daniel. And what's the best phone number to reach you on?

Daniel: It's five-five-five, oh-one-eight-nine.

Maya: Five-five-five, oh-one-eight-nine. Great. Now, we have two sizes of plot. A full plot is about six meters by four, and a half plot is, well, exactly half that.

Daniel: I was thinking of a full plot, actually. I'd like to grow quite a lot of vegetables.

Maya: A lot of new members say that, but a full plot is a big commitment in the first year. Most people find that a half plot is plenty to start with.

Daniel: Hmm, that's probably sensible. I work long hours, so let's say a half plot.

Maya: A half plot, fine. You can always move up to a full plot next season if one's free.

Daniel: And how much is the fee?

Maya: For a half plot, the annual fee is fifty dollars. Oh, wait, sorry, I'm looking at last year's list. It went up in January. It's fifty-five dollars now.

Daniel: That's still very reasonable.

Maya: It covers your water and the shared tools, so most people think so. One more thing: before you can start, every new member has to come to an orientation session.

READ ALOUD

Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at questions 6 to 10. **[PAUSE 30 SECONDS]** Now listen and answer questions 6 to 10.

Daniel: What happens at the orientation?

Maya: It takes about an hour. We show you around, explain the rules, and give you your plot number. The next one is on March the seventh. No, hang on, that one's already full. So the first one with space is Saturday, March the fourteenth, at ten.

Daniel: March the fourteenth, fine. Do I need to bring anything?

Maya: We provide all the tools, spades, forks, wheelbarrows, so you don't need to buy any of those. But please bring your own gloves. For hygiene reasons, we don't lend them out.

Daniel: Gloves, OK. And how do I get into the tool shed when I'm there on my own?

Maya: The shed has a padlock, and members borrow the key. A lot of people assume it's kept at the library, because the library is right next to the gate, but the library closes at five. So we keep it at the bakery across the road. They open at six in the morning.

Daniel: The bakery. That's handy. Is there anything else members have to do?

Maya: Yes. Everyone helps with the shared areas: the paths, the compost, the flower beds by the entrance. We ask for four hours a month, and you can do them whenever it suits you.

Daniel: Four hours a month. That's fine.

Maya: Last question, just for our records: how did you hear about us?

Daniel: Well, my neighbor mentioned the garden last summer, but what actually made me call was an article in the local newspaper last week.

Maya: Oh, good. I'll put the local newspaper, then. That article has brought us a lot of calls.

READ ALOUD

That is the end of Section 1. You now have 30 seconds to check your answers. **[PAUSE 30 SECONDS]**

◆ SECTION 2 • HARBOR POINT LIGHTHOUSE (QUESTIONS 11–20)

READ ALOUD

Section 2. You will hear a guide talking to a group of visitors at a lighthouse. First, you have some time to look at questions 11 to 14. **[PAUSE 30 SECONDS]** Now listen carefully and answer questions 11 to 14.

READ ALOUD

Guide: Good morning, everyone, and welcome to Harbor Point Lighthouse. My name's Grace, and I'll give you a short introduction before you explore on your own.

First, a little history. People often see the date 1868 carved above the door and assume that's when the light first shone. In fact, that's when building began. Storms and a shortage of money slowed the work down, and the lamp wasn't actually lit until 1886. So the lighthouse is a little younger than it looks.

For almost ninety years, keepers and their families lived here and looked after the light. You may hear that they left because of the great storm of 1962, which took the roof off the keeper's cottage. It's a good story, but it isn't true: the cottage was repaired within a year and the keepers stayed. They finally left in 1974, when an automatic lamp was installed, and there was simply no longer any need for someone to be here through the night.

Now, many of you will want to climb the tower, and I'd encourage you to, because the view from the top is wonderful. You don't need to book; just join the line at the bottom of the tower. Children are very welcome, as long as an adult comes up with them. The one thing we do insist on is sensible, flat shoes. The stairs are a narrow metal spiral, so heels, or sandals without a back, aren't allowed. If you've come in the wrong footwear, don't worry: the Visitor Center has a box of spare sneakers you can borrow.

And finally, the tide pools. There are steps down to the rocks, where you can see crabs, starfish and anemones. The steps are open all year round, even in winter, but for your safety they're closed for two hours either side of high tide, because the water comes right up to them. Today, high tide is at half past twelve, so plan to go down this morning or later this afternoon.

READ ALOUD

Before you hear the rest of the talk, you have some time to look at questions 15 to 20. **[PAUSE 30 SECONDS]**
Now listen and answer questions 15 to 20.

READ ALOUD

Guide: Let me show you where everything is on the plan. We're standing at the entrance, at the bottom of the plan, and the main path runs straight up to the lighthouse at the top. The Visitor Center is the large building just inside the entrance on your left, where you bought your tickets.

Directly opposite the Visitor Center, on your right as you come in, is the café. Some of our regular visitors still walk all the way up to the keeper's cottage looking for it, because that's where it used to be, but it moved down here two years ago, so you can get a coffee before you set off.

Just behind the Visitor Center, so to the north of it and still on the left of the path, you'll find the gift shop. It's small, but it has some lovely local crafts.

Halfway up the main path, a side path crosses it. On the right, at that point, there's a small building: that's the restrooms. From there, you can take the side path to the right, and if you follow it all the way to the end, on the east side of the site, you'll come to the picnic area. It's sheltered from the wind, so it's the best place to eat.

If you take the side path to the left instead, and follow it right to the end, near the cliff edge on the western side, that's where the steps down to the tide pools begin.

Carry on up the main path, and just before you reach the lighthouse, on your left, is the keeper's cottage. It's now a small exhibition about the families who lived here.

And finally, if you walk past the lighthouse on its right-hand side, you'll find the lookout platform, right on the cliff edge. It's the best place on the whole site to spot seals. So, enjoy your visit, and do come and find me if you have any questions.

READ ALOUD

That is the end of Section 2. You now have 30 seconds to check your answers. **[PAUSE 30 SECONDS]**

◆ **SECTION 3 • A MUSEUM STUDIES PROJECT (QUESTIONS 21–30)**

READ ALOUD

Section 3. You will hear two students, Kofi and Lena, talking to their tutor, Dr. Hart, about a project for their museum studies course. First, you have some time to look at questions 21 to 25. **[PAUSE 30 SECONDS]** Now listen carefully and answer questions 21 to 25.

Dr. Hart: Come in, both of you. So, you've started your visitor-behavior project. Remind me why you chose the Millbrook museum.

Kofi: Well, it's only ten minutes from campus, which helped, but that wasn't really the reason. The director emailed the department asking if any students could study how visitors move around the building, because they're planning some changes next year.

Dr. Hart: So you have a real client. That's excellent. What have you done so far?

Lena: We've watched visitors on three visits and followed where they went. The first thing we noticed was in the entrance hall. There's a big floor map right in the middle, showing all the rooms, and we expected people to stop and look at it.

Kofi: But almost nobody did. Most people walked straight past it and went into whichever room was nearest.

Dr. Hart: Interesting. How many visitors did you observe?

Lena: Twenty altogether. We were worried that wasn't enough.

Dr. Hart: For a pilot study, twenty is fine. What concerns me more is when you went. You said three visits. Were they all at weekends?

Kofi: Yes, two Saturdays and a Sunday.

Dr. Hart: Then that's the real weakness. Weekday visitors are often school groups or retired people, and they may behave quite differently. You need some weekday sessions before you can say anything general.

Lena: OK, that makes sense.

Dr. Hart: What about the timeline wall? The director mentioned it.

Lena: That was actually where people stopped most. It runs along the whole corridor. But each panel has around three hundred words, and we timed people. Hardly anyone read to the end of a single panel.

Kofi: I did wonder about moving it somewhere quieter, but mainly I agree with Lena: the texts need to be much shorter. Fifty words, maybe, with the details in a leaflet.

Lena: Yes, that's our main point there.

Dr. Hart: And how are you going to record how long people stay at each exhibit?

Kofi: I suggested setting up a couple of small video cameras.

Dr. Hart: You'd need ethics approval to film the public, and that can take months.

Lena: My idea was a stopwatch app on our phones.

Dr. Hart: The trouble is that if visitors see you pointing a phone at them, they'll assume you're filming, and they'll change their behavior. A simple paper grid on a clipboard, with a box for each exhibit, and an ordinary watch, is much less noticeable.

Kofi: Fine. We'll go with the grid.

Before you hear the rest of the conversation, you have some time to look at questions 26 to 30. **[PAUSE 30 SECONDS]** Now listen and answer questions 26 to 30.

Dr. Hart: Now, the director wants one recommendation for each area. Let's go through them. The entrance hall first.

Lena: Well, since nobody uses the floor map, we thought about removing it. But really, the problem is that people don't know where to start. So we'd recommend clear signs: a big one saying "Start here", with arrows to the first room.

Dr. Hart: Good. The farm tools gallery?

Kofi: That's the room where visitors spent the least time. The objects are behind glass, and they all look quite similar. We'd like to add something hands-on. The director said they have a replica butter churn that visitors could actually try.

Dr. Hart: People do remember what they touch. And the textile room?

Lena: It's very dark in there. Our first thought was to recommend brighter lighting.

Dr. Hart: Be careful. Old fabrics fade quickly in strong light, so textile rooms are kept dim deliberately. That's not something the museum can change.

Lena: Oh, I didn't know that. Then maybe audio: a short recording describing the patterns and how each piece was made, so people know what they're looking at, even in low light.

Dr. Hart: That's a far better idea.

Kofi: Then there's the old schoolroom. There are rows of original desks, but they're roped off, and we saw several people, especially grandparents with children, trying to sit down.

Lena: So we'd suggest putting a few replica desks and benches at the back where people can sit. It's already the room where families talk to each other the most.

Dr. Hart: And finally, the photograph corridor.

Kofi: That was the most crowded space. Not with people, with pictures. There are about a hundred and forty photographs on the walls.

Lena: We'd like the museum to choose the best forty or so and store the rest, or show them online. At the moment, people just walk past all of them.

Dr. Hart: Some curators might resist, but I think your evidence supports you. Moving the photographs to another room wouldn't solve anything, would it?

Kofi: No. It's the number, not the place.

READ ALOUD

That is the end of Section 3. You now have 30 seconds to check your answers. **[PAUSE 30 SECONDS]**

READ ALOUD

Section 4. You will hear part of a lecture on architectural acoustics. First, you have some time to look at questions 31 to 40. [PAUSE 45 SECONDS] Now listen carefully and answer questions 31 to 40.

READ ALOUD

Lecturer: Good morning. In today's lecture, I'm going to look at why some concert halls sound wonderful while others, sometimes very expensive ones, disappoint both musicians and audiences. The key idea is something called reverberation. When a musician plays a note and then stops, the sound doesn't disappear at once. It continues for a moment because of reflections from the walls, the ceiling and the floor, which reach our ears slightly later than the original sound. That lingering sound is reverberation.

How much reverberation do we want? It depends on what the room is for. For orchestral music, around two seconds is generally considered ideal: it makes the sound rich and warm. For speech, though, a shorter time is far better, because long reverberation blurs one syllable into the next, and listeners struggle to follow what is being said.

For most of history, halls were designed by trial and error. Architects copied halls that seemed to work and hoped for the best. The first scientific study came at the very end of the nineteenth century, when a young physics lecturer at an American university was asked to fix a lecture room where students simply couldn't understand the speaker. He had no electronic equipment, so he played a note on an organ pipe and timed how long the sound lasted with a stopwatch. Then, late at night, he and his assistants carried in hundreds of cushions borrowed from a nearby theater and measured again. Each time more cushions were added, the reverberation became shorter, and from these experiments he worked out the first formula for predicting it.

Let's turn to shape. Many of the halls that musicians love are what we call "shoebox" halls: long, tall and relatively narrow. Their success seems to come largely from the side walls. Reflections from the side walls reach listeners from the left and right, and this gives the feeling of being surrounded by the music. A more recent design is the "vineyard" hall, where the audience sits on terraces around the stage, a little like the rows of a vineyard on a hillside. This brings everyone closer to the performers, although it is harder to get right acoustically.

Materials matter just as much. Hard surfaces, such as plaster and wood, reflect sound, while soft ones absorb it, and one of the biggest absorbers in any hall is the audience itself, with all its clothing. This created a problem: a hall that sounded perfect in rehearsal could sound dull and dry once it was full. The solution is surprisingly simple. Modern seats are designed to absorb about the same amount of sound when they are empty as when someone is sitting in them, so the hall sounds much the same at a rehearsal as at a sold-out concert.

Designers also have to avoid certain problems. Curved walls, for example, can focus sound on one part of the audience, like a mirror focusing light, and cause echoes. To prevent this, many halls use diffusers:

irregular surfaces, often made of carved wood, which scatter sound in many directions so that it spreads evenly.

Finally, modern halls often host very different kinds of events, from string quartets to amplified pop concerts. So some are now built with adjustable features. The most common are heavy fabric banners that can be lowered from the ceiling to absorb sound and shorten the reverberation when a band brings its own loudspeakers, and raised again for an orchestra.

READ ALOUD

That is the end of the Listening test. You now have 2 minutes to copy your answers onto the answer sheet. **[2 MINUTES]**

◆ TASK 1 DATA TABLE (FOR LEARNERS WITH LOW VISION; GIVE WITH THE GRAPH)

CITY	2000	2005	2010	2015	2020	2025
Northport	12%	18%	27%	38%	46%	52%
Easton	25%	27%	26%	30%	31%	33%
Westvale	5%	7%	14%	30%	44%	55%

The figures are invented for this course. Most learners should work from the graph alone, as in the real test: estimating values from a graph ("just over half", "roughly a quarter") is part of the skill.

SPEAKING · RUN-SHEET FOR CLASS 16

The real Speaking test is a one-to-one interview of **11–14 minutes** in three parts. A class of twelve would need nearly three hours of full interviews, so be realistic and **combine the options below**. Whatever you choose, every learner gets at least one scored long turn (Part 2) and some Part 3 discussion before the course ends.

◆ OPTION A · SHORT-FORM INTERVIEWS IN CLASS (ABOUT 6 MIN EACH)

- ◆ During the 17-minute results block in Class 16, interview **2–3 learners** in a quiet corner: Part 1 (4 questions, ~1.5 min) → Part 2 (1 min preparation + up to 2 min talk) → Part 3 (2–3 questions, ~2 min)
- ◆ **Save time:** hand the next candidate their cue card and pencil while the current candidate is doing Part 3, so their preparation minute overlaps
- ◆ Priority: learners whose Speaking target is closest to a cut-off, and anyone who missed the Class 14 mini mock
- ◆ Write **"SF"** (short form) on the record form. A short interview gives a rougher estimate, especially for Fluency & Coherence

◆ OPTION B · FULL INTERVIEWS OUTSIDE CLASS (13–15 MIN EACH)

- ◆ Offer 15-minute slots before or after class, or on a video call, within about a week of Class 16. In the real test, too, Speaking can take place on a different day from the other sections
- ◆ Use the full-format script below. Let learners book a slot. Don't make the full interview compulsory for anyone who finds a one-to-one interview stressful: the short form is fine
- ◆ **A second interviewer** (co-teacher, trained volunteer) can run Option A in parallel during Class 16 if you brief them with this page and the band-estimation sheet in the key

◆ OPTION C · PEER INTERVIEWS FOR EVERYONE ELSE (DURING THE SAME 17 MINUTES)

Learners who are not being interviewed pair up once they have finished their error analysis. **Student A** is the examiner: they read three Part 1 questions from one set, hand over a cue card, time one minute of preparation and up to two minutes of talking, then ask two Part 3 questions. **Student B** answers and records the whole thing on a phone. Then they swap, using a different card. At home, each learner listens back and scores themselves with the speaking band-estimation sheet in the key, then writes one sentence about the criterion that is holding them back (the Lesson 4.2 routine). Check the instructions first:

SAY: *Who asks the questions first? (Student A.) How long is the preparation time? (One minute.) How long is the talk? (Up to two minutes.) Do you stop your partner if they are still talking at two minutes? (Yes, politely.) What do you do with the recording? (Listen at home and score it with the sheet.) Do you have to tell the truth about yourself? (No. Real or invented, both are fine.)*

FULL-FORMAT INTERVIEW SCRIPT (11–14 MIN)

Sit at an angle to the candidate, not directly opposite. Keep your face friendly but neutral, and don't nod "yes" to correct grammar. Use a timer the candidate can't see. Don't correct, teach or give feedback during the interview.

That comes later, and in writing. If a candidate freezes, repeat the question once more slowly, then move on: in the real test, the examiner does the same.

PART	TIME	YOU SAY / DO
Opening	~30 sec	"Hello, and thanks for coming. My name is _____. Could you tell me your full name? And what would you like me to call you? This is a practice interview in three parts. I'll ask you some questions, and at times I may stop you. That's part of the timing; it doesn't mean anything is wrong." (<i>In the real test, the examiner also checks identification. Skip that here.</i>)
Part 1 · everyday topics	4–5 min	"First, let's talk about some everyday things." Choose one set below and ask the questions from 2–3 topics , about 4 questions per topic. Let answers run for 2–4 sentences. If an answer is one word, wait two seconds before asking the next question; many candidates will extend on their own.
Part 2 · long turn	3–4 min	"Now I'll give you a card with a topic on it. You'll have one minute to prepare, and you can write notes on this paper. Then I'd like you to talk for up to two minutes. I'll stop you when the time is up." Hand over the card, paper and pencil. After 1 minute: "Please begin when you're ready." Stop them at 2 minutes: "Thank you." Then ask the rounding-off question on the card (one or two sentences are enough). Collect the card and notes.
Part 3 · discussion	4–5 min	"We've been talking about _____. Now I'd like to ask you some more general questions connected to this." Ask the Part 3 questions for the same card, following up with <i>Why?</i> , <i>Can you give an example?</i> or <i>Is that true everywhere?</i> The aim is to find the highest level at which the candidate can speculate, compare and justify.
Close	~10 sec	"Thank you. That's the end of the interview." Smile; say nothing about how it went. Fill in the record form immediately, before the next candidate sits down.

PART 1 · QUESTION SETS

Use a different set for each candidate who is interviewed within earshot of others. None of these questions asks about home country, family or status; don't add follow-ups that do. "The place where you live now" can be real or invented.

PART 1 • SET 1

Work or studies

- 1 Do you work, or are you a student at the moment?
- 2 What do you enjoy most about your work or studies?
- 3 Is there anything about it you would like to change?
- 4 Do you find it easier to concentrate in the morning or in the evening? Why?

Reading

- 1 Do you read much in your free time?
- 2 What kinds of things do you like to read?
- 3 Do you prefer printed books or reading on a screen? Why?
- 4 Is there a book you would recommend to a friend?

Weather

- 1 What kind of weather do you enjoy most?
- 2 Does the weather ever change your plans?
- 3 Is there a time of year you particularly look forward to?

PART 1 • SET 2

The place where you live now

- 1 What do you like about the area where you live now?
- 2 Is it a quiet place or a busy one?
- 3 What is one thing that would make it a better place to live?
- 4 Do you think you will live there for a long time?

Cooking

- 1 Do you enjoy cooking?
- 2 How did you learn to cook?
- 3 Is there a dish you would like to learn to make?
- 4 Do you prefer eating at home or eating out? Why?

Music

- 1 What kind of music do you listen to?
- 2 When do you usually listen to music?
- 3 Have your tastes in music changed over the years?

Daily routine

- 1 What is the busiest part of your day?
- 2 Do you usually do the same things every day?
- 3 Is there anything you would like to change about your routine?
- 4 What do you like to do when you have a free hour?

Getting around

- 1 How do you usually travel around your town or city?
- 2 What do you think of public transport where you live now?
- 3 Would you rather walk or cycle for short trips? Why?

Photographs

- 1 Do you enjoy taking photographs?
- 2 What do you usually do with your photos?
- 3 Do you prefer taking photos or being in them?

STRETCH AND SUPPORT

If a candidate is very strong

Part 1 should stay simple, so don't make the questions harder. Save the challenge for Part 3 and push further there: "Why do you think that is?", "Would that be true in twenty years' time?", "What would someone who disagrees say?"

If a candidate is struggling

Repeat the question once, slowly. Don't rephrase it, because in the real test the examiner repeats but does not explain. In Part 2, if they stop after 40 seconds, say only: "Can you tell me any more about that?" If they still can't continue, move on kindly. A short Part 2 is information for the debrief, not a failure.

PART 2 · CUE CARDS (CUT OUT)

CARD 1

Describe a public place in your town or city where you like to spend time.

You should say:

- where it is
- what it looks like
- what people usually do there

and explain why you enjoy spending time there.

Rounding-off (teacher): Do you usually go there alone or with other people?

CARD 2

Describe a time when someone taught you something useful.

You should say:

- who the person was
- what they taught you
- how they taught it

and explain why it turned out to be useful.

Rounding-off (teacher): Have you ever taught this to anyone else?

CARD 3

Describe a piece of technology, other than a phone, that you find useful.

You should say:

- what it is
- when you started using it
- how often you use it

and explain how it has changed the way you do something.

Rounding-off (teacher): Is there anything you dislike about it?

NEW IDENTITY PROMPTS (OPTIONAL)

Any candidate may invent the details. Quick ideas to offer if someone asks: **Card 1** a riverside walk with benches and a food market on Sundays · **Card 2** a former colleague who taught you to use spreadsheets for a household budget · **Card 3** a slow cooker, a pair of noise-canceling headphones, or an e-reader.

PART 3 · DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Ask the set that matches the Part 2 card. You won't need all of them: 4–5 well-developed answers fill 4–5 minutes. Move from the more concrete questions (first) to the more abstract ones (last).

◆ AFTER CARD 1 • PUBLIC PLACES

- 1 Why do cities need public spaces such as parks and squares?
- 2 Should public spaces be designed mainly for young people, or for everyone equally?
- 3 How has technology changed the way people behave in public places?
- 4 Who should pay to maintain public spaces: local government, businesses, or the people who use them?
- 5 Some people say modern cities are becoming less friendly. How far do you agree?
- 6 How do you think public spaces might be different thirty years from now?

◆ AFTER CARD 3 • TECHNOLOGY IN DAILY LIFE

- 1 Has technology made daily life more stressful or less stressful? Why?
- 2 Why do some people find it hard to start using new technology?
- 3 Should schools teach people how to repair everyday machines?
- 4 Is it a good thing that machines now do so many household tasks?
- 5 How do you think technology will change the way people work over the next twenty years?
- 6 Are there situations where people should choose *not* to use technology?

◆ AFTER CARD 2 • LEARNING FROM OTHERS

- 1 Do people learn practical skills better from family and friends or from professionals? Why?
- 2 Is it easier to learn something from an online video than from a person?
- 3 What qualities make someone good at explaining things?
- 4 Should employers be responsible for teaching new staff, or should people arrive already trained?
- 5 Which practical skills do you think young adults today are not learning? Does it matter?
- 6 How might the way adults learn new skills change in the future?

◆ WHAT TO LISTEN FOR IN PART 3

- ◆ A clear answer first, then a reason, an example, and a contrast or qualification (the Lesson 4.1 extension routine)
- ◆ Speculation and hypothesis: *It's likely that..., If cities invested in..., people would...*
- ◆ General, not only personal, examples: *In many cities..., For older people...*
- ◆ Paraphrase when a word is missing (Lesson 4.2), without long silences

SPEAKING RECORD FORM (ONE PER CANDIDATE)

Candidate: _____ Date: _____ Format: Full / SF Part 1 set: ____ Card: ____ Part 2
length: ____ min ____ sec

CRITERION	NOTES WHILE LISTENING (EXAMPLES, ERRORS, STRENGTHS)	BAND ESTIMATE
Fluency & Coherence	length of answers · pauses (searching for language, or thinking about ideas?) · self-correction · linking and signposting	
Lexical Resource	topic words · collocation · less common or idiomatic items · paraphrase when a word is missing · repetition of basic words	
Grammatical Range & Accuracy	complex sentences (conditionals, relative clauses, passives) · tense control · how many sentences are error-free	
Pronunciation	how easy to follow · word and sentence stress · intonation · chunking and linking	
Estimated Speaking band (average of the four, rounded to the nearest half band) · one strength · one next step		

Use the band-estimation sheet in [assessment/practice-test-2-key.html](#). It paraphrases the public IELTS band descriptors in plain language. Your estimate is a teacher's estimate, not an official score: say so when you give it back.

AFTER CLASS 16: CLOSE THE LOOP

Estimate each Writing script and each speaking record with the key within a week, and give every learner a one-page result: **four skill bands (two raw-score conversions, two estimates), an approximate overall, their Practice Test 1 bands beside them, one strength, and the one change with the biggest payoff.** The key's debrief plan has wording for a gain, for no change, and for a drop, plus retake guidance for learners who have already taken the real test.